

can guide them to the right templates, decision logs, and 'how we do things here' patterns so they contribute sooner. These benefits sound straightforward. So why are teams not already living this future? Because AI is only as good as the context it is given.

Secret Ingredient: Context

A modern AI model can summon a lot of general information. But it usually knows nothing about the living reality inside your organisation. It does not automatically know which wording your compliance team insists on, which metrics trigger escalation, which vendor delays are normal, or what your boss means by 'keep it short'.

That is why the next chapter of AI at work will not be won by the fanciest model. It will be won by the teams that master context. Context is the organisation's recipe. The ingredients are your rules, your workflows, your templates, your decision history, and the small habits that make your company unique. And context engineering is the craft of packaging that recipe so AI can follow it reliably, safely and repeatedly. Done well, the same AI stops behaving like a generic chatbot and starts behaving like someone who has actually been hired into your business. Done poorly, it produces confident answers that do not fit your reality.

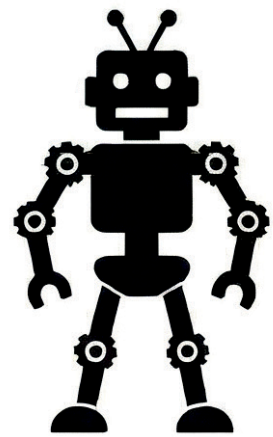
Action Fits, Minus the Hype

Once an AI has enough context, it can do more than suggest. It can take action within clearly defined boundaries. It can run repeatable workflows, it can draft a contract in your house style, prepare an audit packet with supporting evidence, reconcile exceptions, route an approval, or flag a missing step. Humans still handle judgement calls and exceptions. In other words, multi-player AI can evolve into agents that operate across tools, not just inside a chat box.

In enterprise settings, one practical idea is 'run-time context'. This means feeding the AI the specific situational details of the work item while it is executing, so it does not guess and does not behave generically. When context is captured properly, knowledge is no longer trapped in a few people's heads. Teams become less dependent on gatekeepers, and younger employees can ramp up faster. That can be good for speed, but also good for fairness.

TAKEAWAYS

- **AI will participate in shared flow of work in teams. Think less 'my assistant' and more 'our colleague'**
- **The next chapter of AI at work will not be won by the fanciest model but by the teams that master context**
- **We'll see AI as a participant in how work flows, moving from the side of the desk to the actual machinery of collaboration**



DONE WELL, **THE SAME AI STOPS BEHAVING LIKE A GENERIC CHATBOT** AND STARTS BEHAVING LIKE SOMEONE WHO HAS ACTUALLY BEEN HIRED INTO YOUR BUSINESS. DONE POORLY, **IT PRODUCES CONFIDENT ANSWERS THAT DO NOT FIT YOUR REALITY**

Prediction for 2026

We will stop talking about AI as a tool you open, and start experiencing AI as a participant in how work flows. It will move from the side of the desk into the actual machinery of collaboration. The winners will not be the teams that 'use AI for everything'. They will be the teams that decide which work is repeatable enough to delegate, which moments require human judgement, and which context makes the whole system trustworthy.

Because in the AI model era, context or local team knowledge is the real raw material. It becomes a source of advantage that competitors cannot copy overnight. Multi-player AI is coming. Super agents will be one of its most visible forms. But the deeper story, the one your grandmother can relate to, is simpler than it sounds.

The future office will have a new kind of colleague: one that remembers what the team learned the hard way, and helps everyone move faster with fewer mistakes. ■

Rohan N. Murty is Founder, Workfabric AI